

Word family: **deadline / deadlines**

Base word: deadline

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Related forms:

* **deadline** (n.) — 截止日期；截止時間；最後期限

* **deadlines** (plural) — 多個截止期限

* **deadline-driven** (adj.) — 以截止期限推動的；期限導向的

* **deadline pressure** — 截止期限帶來的壓力

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **meet a deadline**

* **miss a deadline**

* **set a deadline**

* **give someone a deadline**

* **extend a deadline**

* **deadline extension**

* **tight deadline**

* **strict deadline**

* **final deadline**

* **application deadline**

* **submission deadline**

* **payment deadline**

* **deadline for something**

* **deadline to do something**

* **work to a deadline**

* **work under a deadline**

* **deadline pressure**

* **deadline is approaching**

* **deadline is looming**

* **deadline is breathing down your neck**

* **rolling deadline**

Meaning in this passage

> The **deadline** was breathing down our necks, so everyone was tired, tense, and a little irritable.

Here, **deadline** means:

**the final time by which the university presentation had to be completed or submitted — 截止

時間；最後期限**

The phrase **the deadline was breathing down our necks** means the deadline was extremely close and creating pressure.

中文翻譯：

截止日期已經逼在眼前，所以大家都很累、很緊張，也有點容易煩躁。

So here:

deadline = 某項工作必須在此日期或時間之前完成的最後期限

1. **deadline (截止日期 / 截止時間) — 截止日期**

This is the core modern meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> The **deadline** was breathing down our necks.

截止日期已經逼在眼前。

Practice 2

> The **deadline** for the assignment is Friday.

這份功課的**截止日期**是星期五。

Practice 3

> We need to finish before the **deadline**.

我們需要在**截止日期**前完成。

MCQ-ready definition:

deadline = 某項工作、申請、付款或任務必須完成的最後日期或時間

2. **deadline for something — 某事的截止日期**

Practice 1

> The **deadline for applications** is May 1.

申請的**截止日期**是 5 月 1 日。

Practice 2

> What's the **deadline for this project**?

這個項目的**截止日期**是甚麼時候？

MCQ-ready definition:

deadline for X = X 必須完成、提交或處理的最後日期 / 時間

3. **deadline to do something — 做某事的最後期限**

Practice 1

> The **deadline to submit the form** is tomorrow.

提交表格的**最後期限**是明天。

Practice 2

> We were given a **deadline to complete the work**.

我們獲指定一個完成工作的**截止日期**。

MCQ-ready definition:

deadline to do X = 必須在指定時間前完成 X

4. **meet a deadline — 準時趕上截止日期**

A very important collocation.

Practice 1

> We worked late to **meet the deadline**.

我們工作至很晚，以便**趕上截止日期**。

Practice 2

> She always ****meets her deadlines****.

她總能****按時完成工作****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****meet a deadline = 在指定的最後期限前成功完成或提交某事****

5. ****miss a deadline — 錯過截止日期；逾期****

Practice 1

> We can't afford to ****miss the deadline****.

我們不能****錯過截止日期****。

Practice 2

> He ****missed the application deadline****.

他****錯過了申請截止日期****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****miss a deadline = 未能在最後期限前完成、提交或處理某事****

6. ****set a deadline — 設定截止日期****

Practice 1

> The teacher ****set a deadline**** for Friday.

老師把****截止日期定在**星期五**。

Practice 2

> We should ****set a clear deadline**** for the project.

我們應為項目****設定清楚的期限****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****set a deadline = 決定某件事必須在哪個日期或時間前完成****

7. ****give someone a deadline — 給某人一個期限****

Practice 1

> The manager ****gave us a deadline**** of two weeks.

經理****給我們兩星期期限****。

Practice 2

> They were ****given a deadline**** to respond.

他們獲給予一個回覆的****最後期限****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****give someone a deadline = 指定某人必須在某個時間前完成事情****

8. ****extend the deadline — 延長截止日期****

Practice 1

> The university ****extended the deadline**** by one week.

大學把****截止日期延長了一星期****。

Practice 2

> Could you ****extend the deadline****?

可以****延長截止日期****嗎？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****extend a deadline = 把原本的最後期限推遲至較後時間****

9. ****deadline extension — 延期；延長截止日期****

Practice 1

> We asked for a ****deadline extension****.

我們要求****延長截止日期****。

Practice 2

> No further **deadline extensions** will be granted.

不會再批准**延期**。

MCQ-ready definition:

deadline extension = 把原有截止日期推遲的正式安排

10. **tight deadline** — 時間很趕的期限；緊迫期限

Practice 1

> We were working to a **tight deadline**.

我們正在一個**非常緊迫的期限**下工作。

Practice 2

> The team completed the project despite the **tight deadline**.

雖然**時間很趕**，團隊仍完成了項目。

MCQ-ready definition:

tight deadline = 可用時間很少、令人需要快速完成工作的期限

11. **strict deadline** — 嚴格截止日期

Practice 1

> The application has a **strict deadline**.

申請有一個**嚴格的截止日期**。

Practice 2

> This is a **strict deadline**, so late submissions will not be accepted.

這是一個**嚴格的截止日期**，逾期提交將不獲接受。

MCQ-ready definition:

****strict deadline = 不容輕易延期或逾期的截止時間****

12. ****final deadline — 最終期限****

Practice 1

> Monday is the ****final deadline****.

星期一是****最終截止日期****。

Practice 2

> The ****final deadline**** cannot be extended.

****最終期限****不能再延長。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****final deadline = 最後且通常不能再推遲的期限****

13. ****application deadline — 申請截止日期****

Practice 1

> The ****application deadline**** is next Friday.

****申請截止日期****是下星期五。

Practice 2

> I submitted everything before the ****application deadline****.

我在****申請截止期限****前提交了所有資料。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****application deadline = 接受申請的最後日期或時間****

14. ****submission deadline — 提交截止日期****

Practice 1

> The **submission deadline** is midnight.

提交截止時間是午夜。

Practice 2

> Students were reminded of the **submission deadline**.

學生獲提醒注意**提交期限**。

MCQ-ready definition:

submission deadline = 文件、作業或作品必須提交的最後時間

15. **payment deadline** — 付款期限

Practice 1

> The **payment deadline** is the end of the month.

付款期限是月底。

Practice 2

> A late fee applies if you miss the **payment deadline**.

如果錯過**付款期限**，就需要繳交逾期費用。

MCQ-ready definition:

payment deadline = 款項必須支付的最後日期或時間

16. **work to a deadline** — 在期限要求下工作

Especially common in BrE.

Practice 1

> Journalists often **work to tight deadlines**.

記者經常要**在很趕的期限下工作**。

Practice 2

> I'm used to **working to deadlines**.

我習慣**按期限完成工作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

work to a deadline = 以指定完成期限為目標安排並完成工作

17. **work under a deadline** — 在截止期限壓力下工作

Practice 1

> People often feel stressed when **working under a deadline**.

人在**期限壓力下工作**時往往會感到緊張。

Practice 2

> The team was **working under a very tight deadline**.

團隊當時正**在非常緊迫的期限下工作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

work under a deadline = 在必須於某個時間前完成工作的壓力下工作

18. **deadline pressure** — 截止期限壓力

Practice 1

> **Deadline pressure** can lead to mistakes.

截止期限壓力可能導致錯誤。

Practice 2

> Everyone was tired because of the **deadline pressure**.

因為**趕 deadline 的壓力**，大家都很累。

MCQ-ready definition:

deadline pressure = 因必須在有限時間內完成工作而產生的壓力

19. **the deadline is approaching — 截止日期臨近**

Practice 1

> The **deadline is approaching** quickly.

截止日期很快就到了。

Practice 2

> Everyone became busier as the **deadline approached**.

隨着**截止日期臨近**，大家都忙了起來。

MCQ-ready definition:

deadline approaches = 距離最後期限愈來愈近

20. **looming deadline — 迫近的截止日期**

A very useful expression.

Practice 1

> The **looming deadline** made everyone nervous.

迫近的截止日期令所有人都很緊張。

Practice 2

> She worked late because of a **looming deadline**.

因為**期限逼近**，她工作到很晚。

MCQ-ready definition:

looming deadline = 即將到來並令人感受到壓力的截止日期

21. **deadline is breathing down your neck — 截止日期逼在眼前**

This is the exact figurative construction in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> The **deadline was breathing down our necks**.

截止日期已經逼在眼前。

Practice 2

> It's hard to think clearly when a **deadline is breathing down your neck**.

當**截止日期逼得很近**時，很難清楚思考。

MCQ-ready definition:

deadline breathing down your neck = 截止日期非常接近，令人感到強烈時間壓力

22. **rolling deadline — 滾動式截止安排；隨到隨審期限**

Practice 1

> The programme has a **rolling deadline**.

這個計劃採用**滾動式申請期限**。

Practice 2

> Applications are reviewed under a **rolling deadline system**.

申請以**隨到隨審的期限安排**處理。

MCQ-ready definition:

rolling deadline = 沒有單一固定截止日，而是在某段期間內持續接受或分批處理申請的安排

23. **deadline (新聞 / 出版：截稿時間) — 截稿期限**

This is not a fundamentally separate concept, but it has a very established professional use.

Practice 1

> The journalist was rushing to meet the **deadline**.

記者正趕着在**截稿期限**前完成稿件。

Practice 2

> The newspaper's **deadline** is 8 p.m.

報社的**截稿時間**是晚上八時。

MCQ-ready definition:

deadline = 新聞、出版等工作必須交稿或完成製作的最後時間

24. **deadline** (電腦 / 實時系統：必須完成的最後時間) — 時限；截止時間

A technical extension, but based on the same core meaning.

Practice 1

> The task must finish before its processing **deadline**.

這項工作必須在處理**時限**前完成。

Practice 2

> Missing a real-time **deadline** can cause system failure.

錯過實時系統的**時限**可能導致系統故障。

MCQ-ready definition:

deadline = 在電腦或實時系統中，某項運算必須完成的最遲時間

Important distinction 1: **deadline** vs **due date**

Very close.

deadline

emphasizes the **latest acceptable point**.

due date

the date something is expected or scheduled.

> assignment deadline

功課截止期限

> payment due date

付款到期日

In many academic contexts they are almost interchangeable, but **deadline** often carries stronger “cannot be later than this” pressure.

Important distinction 2: **deadline** vs cutoff / cut-off

deadline

last time for completing/submitting something.

cutoff

point after which something is no longer accepted, counted, or allowed.

> application deadline

申請截止日期

> age cutoff

年齡界線

A cutoff does not always involve completing a task.

Important distinction 3: **deadline** vs time limit

deadline

fixed latest time/date.

time limit

amount of time allowed.

> Deadline: Friday at 5 p.m.

截止：星期五下午五時

> Time limit: 60 minutes.

限時：60 分鐘

Very important distinction.

Important distinction 4: **deadline vs schedule**

deadline

one final completion point.

schedule

overall arrangement of times and activities.

A project can be on schedule but still have several future deadlines.

Important distinction 5: **deadline vs target date**

target date

desired/planned date and may be more flexible.

deadline

normally firmer and represents the latest acceptable date.

> target completion date

目標完成日期

> final deadline

最終截止日期

Important distinction 6: **meet vs beat a deadline**

meet a deadline

finish on time.

beat a deadline

finish before the deadline, often comfortably.

> We met the deadline.

我們準時完成。

> We beat the deadline by two days.

我們比期限早兩天完成。

25. **beat a deadline — 提前趕及期限**

Practice 1

> We **beat the deadline by one day**.

我們比**截止日期早一天完成**。

Practice 2

> The team worked efficiently and **beat the deadline**.

團隊高效工作，**提前完成了任務**。

MCQ-ready definition:

beat a deadline = 在最後期限之前提早完成工作

Important distinction 7: **miss a deadline vs be late**

be late

very broad.

miss a deadline

specifically fail to complete/submit before the cutoff.

> I was late for class.

我上課遲到。

> I missed the assignment deadline.

我錯過了功課截止時間。

Important distinction 8: **extend vs postpone a deadline**

extend a deadline

move the deadline later and give more time.

postpone something

move the event/activity itself later.

> extend the submission deadline

延長提交期限

> postpone the presentation

延遲簡報日期

Important distinction 9: **tight deadline vs strict deadline**

tight deadline

very little time available.

strict deadline

late work is not accepted / rule is firm.

A deadline can be:

- * tight but flexible,
- * strict but not tight,
- * both.

Important distinction 10: ****approaching vs looming deadline****

****approaching deadline****

neutral: getting closer.

****looming deadline****

suggests psychological pressure or concern.

Your passage's ****breathing down our necks**** is even more vivid than ****looming****.

Important distinction 11: ****deadline itself is not the same as workload****

A deadline is just the final time.

The ****pressure**** comes from:

- * how much work remains,
- * how close the deadline is,
- * consequences of missing it.

So:

> tight deadline

often implies pressure, but ****deadline**** itself simply identifies the limit.

Important distinction 12: ****deadline is countable****

- > a deadline
- > two deadlines
- > several deadlines

Examples:

> I have three deadlines this week.

我今星期有三個截止日期。

Important distinction 13: **deadline** is normally used with prepositions carefully

Common:

- > deadline **for** applications
- > deadline **for submitting** applications
- > deadline **to submit** applications

Also:

- > submit something **by** the deadline

Not:

- > **submit on deadline** ❌ in ordinary learner English

Use:

- > by the deadline ✅
- > before the deadline ✅

Important distinction 14: **by the deadline** vs **before the deadline**

by the deadline

no later than the deadline; completing exactly at the deadline still counts.

before the deadline

earlier than the deadline.

So:

- > submit by Friday at 5

can include Friday at 5.

- > submit before Friday at 5

must be earlier.

Important distinction 15: **deadline vs milestone**

deadline

last permitted completion time.

milestone

important progress point in a longer project.

> draft deadline

草稿截止日期

> project milestone

項目里程碑

A milestone may have its own deadline, but they are not the same thing.

Family-extension note

Unlike words such as **mark** or **grade**, **deadline** does not have many genuinely separate everyday meanings.

Its modern semantic core remains very stable:

the latest acceptable time for something to be completed

Most variation comes from **domain and collocation**, rather than true polysemy:

1. **academic**

* assignment deadline

* submission deadline

2. **work/project**

* meet a deadline

* tight deadline

3. **applications/payment**

* application deadline

* payment deadline

4. **journalism/publishing**

* press deadline

* copy deadline

5. **technical computing**

* real-time deadline

And its strongest figurative use comes from how we describe the pressure of time:

* looming deadline

* deadline approaching

* deadline breathing down your neck

So this is a good example of a word where we should **search exhaustively but split conservatively**: there is one dominant modern concept with many useful constructions.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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deadline	截止日期 / 最後期限	latest acceptable time
deadline for X	X 的截止日期	target task
deadline to do X	做 X 的最後期限	required action
meet a deadline	趕上期限	complete on time
miss a deadline	錯過期限	complete too late
beat a deadline	提前完成	finish early
set a deadline	設定期限	establish limit
give someone a deadline	給某人期限	impose limit
extend a deadline	延長期限	move later
deadline extension	截止延期	extra time
tight deadline	緊迫期限	little time
strict deadline	嚴格期限	no lateness allowed
final deadline	最終期限	last possible deadline
application deadline	申請截止日期	applications
submission deadline	提交截止日期	submissions
payment deadline	付款期限	payment
work to a deadline	按期限工作	deadline-driven work
deadline pressure	截止期限壓力	time pressure
approaching deadline	臨近的期限	getting closer
looming deadline	迫近的期限	threateningly close

breathing down your neck	逼在眼前	intense proximity	
rolling deadline	滾動式期限	ongoing acceptance	
press deadline	截稿期限	journalism	
real-time deadline	實時運算時限	computing	

For your original sentence

> The **deadline was breathing down our necks**, so everyone was tired, tense, and a little irritable.

Here:

deadline = 那個簡報必須完成的最後期限

and:

the deadline was breathing down our necks = 截止期限已逼在眼前，時間壓力非常大

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> **截止期限已經逼在眼前**，所以大家都很累、很緊張，也有點容易煩躁。

The vivid metaphor is important: a deadline cannot literally **breathe**, but it is personified as something standing immediately behind you, creating the feeling that **time is chasing you**.